



HACK4VILNIUS 2026

Pitch Guide: From Idea to Final

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How to show a weekend of work in 5 minutes

Five minutes that decide everything

(3 + 2) + 3

minutes in the final

3 min challenge and solution

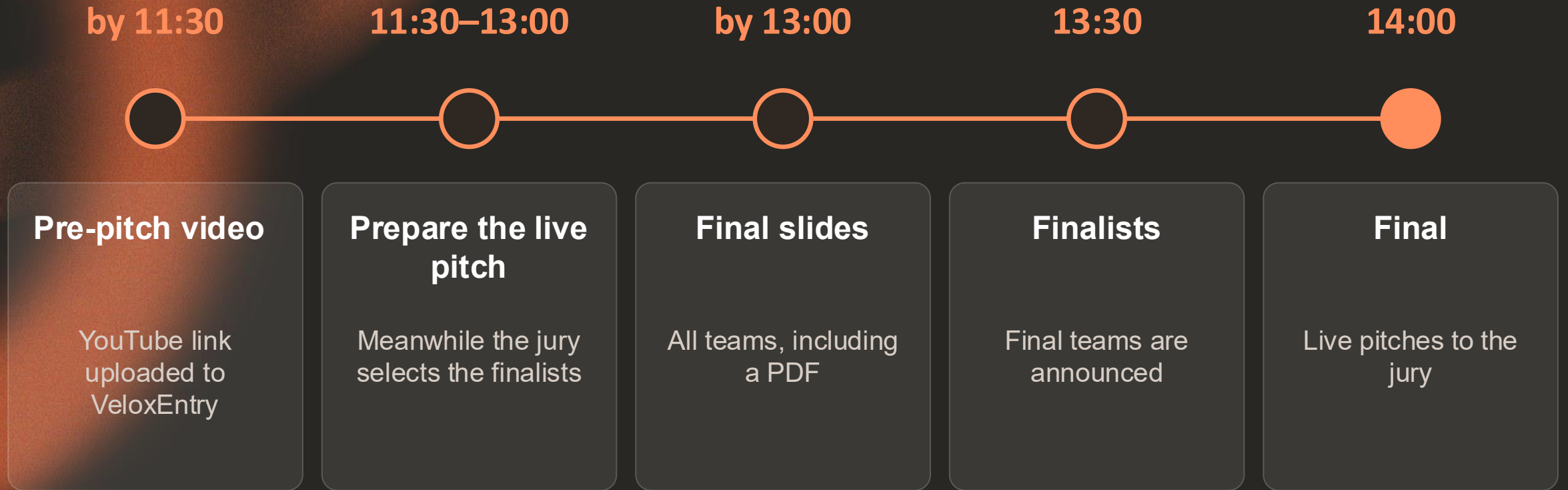
+2 min prototype demo

+3 min jury questions

The jury does not see your code. It sees your pitch.

- Your weekend of work is judged by what you manage to show in a few minutes.
- You will use the same pitch twice: in the pre-pitch video and in the live final.
- A strong prototype without a clear story often loses to a weaker one that is told clearly.
- Start preparing your pitch on Saturday, not on Sunday morning.

Sunday, 11 October: the road to the final



The video and the slides are required from every team: without them you cannot reach the final.

Pre-pitch video



Requirements

Length	up to 5 min
Format	YouTube link, Public or Unlisted.
Deadline	11 October, 11:30 AM.
Where	VeloxEntry → Hackathon → Submission.



How to record it well

- Follow the final structure: 3 min idea, 2 min demo.
- Show the demo as a screen recording with voice-over.
- Sound matters more than picture: a quiet room, the mic close.
- Record early so there is time to fix things.
- Check the link in an incognito window. The jury cannot open a Private video.

Final format: 5 min.

3 min

Challenge and solution

What problem you solve, for whom and how. No demo.

+2 min

Prototype demo

How what you built works. If there is no demo, show how far you got.

+3 min

Jury questions

Short, clear answers. This time is judged too.

Rehearse with a timer at least three times. Whatever does not fit in the time does not happen.

How the jury will judge



1. Innovation and benefit to Vilnius

What is new about it? What will improve in Vilnius, and by how much?



2. Business and market potential

Who will use it, who will pay, how it will grow.



3. Execution and use of open data

What actually works and which open data you used.



4. Overall pitch quality

A clear story, on time, confident answers.

The criteria are the same in the pre-pitch selection and in the final.

Pitch structure: 7 parts

1 Team ~15 s

2 Challenge and problem ~45 s

3 Solution (no demo) ~60 s

4 Execution level and demo +2 min

5 Customers and users ~20 s

6 Benefit to the city ~20 s

7 Next steps ~20 s

Parts 1–3 and 5–7 together make up 3 min. The time split is a recommendation, not a rule.

1–2. Team and problem

Team

- One sentence: who you are and why you are the ones solving this problem.
- Names and roles can fit on one slide. Not a CV.

Problem

- Start with a person and a situation in Vilnius.
- Give numbers that shows the scale, ideally from open data.
- Why do existing solutions do not work?
- Is it a real problem or opportunity?

WEAK

“Older people find it hard to get around the city.”

STRONG

“Ona, 74, from Fabijoniškės does not know whether her stop has a bench or whether a low-floor bus will come, so she stays home more often.”

3–4. Solution and demo

We help **[whom]** **[do what]** by **[how it works]**.

Solution

- Product (Device, Tool, Item) or Service (App, SaaS, Data, Report, Information)?
- Talk **about what the user gets**, not which technologies you used.
- One core feature is worth more than ten half-finished ones.
- Why this is possible now: data, technology, a partner.

Demo

- One scenario from start to finish.
- Data prepared in advance: no logins, no waiting.
- Backup plan: a recorded demo or screenshots.
- Say honestly what works and what is a mock-up.

4. Open data: show it, don't just mention it.



Data

Name the specific dataset and its source.



Insight

Show one chart or number you got from it.



Solution

Explain how the data works inside your product.

Saying “we use open data” earns no points. A specific dataset and an insight you show do.

5–7. Users, benefit and what comes next



Customers and users

- Who will use it every day?
- Who will pay? It may not be the same people.
- How many such people are in Vilnius?



Benefit to the city

- Time, money or emissions saved, or greater safety.
- One measurable indicator.



Next steps

- What happens after the hackathon: a pilot, partners.
- What you need from the municipality or companies.

Jury questions: prepare in advance

Likely questions

How is your solution different from existing ones?

Where will you get the data in the long term?

Who will pay for it?

What in the demo really worked, and what was a mock-up?

What is your first step next month?

What are the benefits for Vilnius city?

How to answer

- Answer first, then explain.
- Agree in advance who answers technical questions and who answers business ones.
- “We don't know yet, but we would test it like this...” beats dodging the question.
- A question is not criticism: it is a chance to show you have thought further.

The most common mistakes



Intro too long

A minute on the team leaves no time for the problem.



Tech stack list

Listing libraries instead of the benefit to the user.



Demo won't load

No backup recording, and the hall's internet is slow.



Too much text

Slides are read out instead of told.



Over time

The ending gets cut: benefits and next steps.



Unclear user

The jury never learns who the solution is for.

Submitting final slides by 13:00 (1:00 PM) on Sunday

- ✓ **Format** PPT, PPTX or PDF; Canva, Gamma or Prezi as a public link only
- ✓ **Backup PDF** Required from every team, even if you present from Canva, Gamma, Google Slides or Prezi etc.
- ✓ **Where** Your team's folder in the shared **Google Drive**. **Shared link / URL needs to be provided at VeloxEntry.**
- ✓ **VeloxEntry** → Hackathon → Submission.
- ✓ **Check** That the link opens in an incognito window, without logging in

Good slides

- One idea per slide.
- Large font, readable from the back row.
- Screenshots / Pictures of the prototype instead of descriptions.
- Team name and challenge on the first slide.

All teams submit slides by 13:00 (1:00 PM), before knowing whether they made the final.

The jury



Gintarė Galinaitė

Cognizant Technology Solutions
Lithuania



Irmantas Znatinas

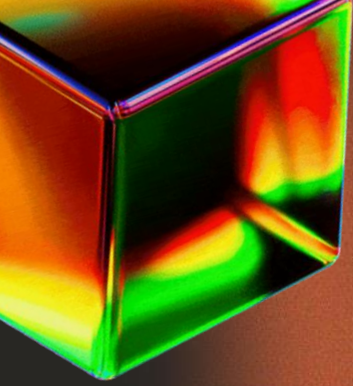
Vilnius City Municipality



Lina Adomonienė

Ignitis Group

Prepare for three perspectives: technology, the city and business.



Good luck in the final!

Questions?

Laurynas Braškus · Saulėtekio Tech Parkas

Deadlines: Sunday: 11:30 video · 13:00 slides and PDF · 14:00 final

